

Working Group
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r: Standards Track

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Lightweight Directory Access Protocol (LDAP): Technical Specification Road Map

of This Memo

document specifies an Internet standards track protocol for the
net community, and requests discussion and suggestions for
vements. Please refer to the current edition of the "Internet
ial Protocol Standards" (STD 1) for the standardization state
status of this protocol. Distribution of this memo is unlimited.

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lightweight Directory Access Protocol (LDAP) is an Internet
col for accessing distributed directory services that act in
dance with X.500 data and service models. This document
des a road map of the LDAP Technical Specification.

LDAP Technical Specification

technical specification detailing version 3 of the Lightweight
tory Access Protocol (LDAP), an Internet Protocol, consists of
document and the following documents:

AP: The Protocol [[RFC4511](#)]
AP: Directory Information Models [[RFC4512](#)]
AP: Authentication Methods and Security Mechanisms [[RFC4513](#)]
AP: String Representation of Distinguished Names [[RFC4514](#)]
AP: String Representation of Search Filters [[RFC4515](#)]
AP: Uniform Resource Locator [[RFC4516](#)]
AP: Syntaxes and Matching Rules [[RFC4517](#)]
AP: Internationalized String Preparation [[RFC4518](#)]
AP: Schema for User Applications [[RFC4519](#)]

Terms "LDAP" and "LDAPv3" are commonly used to refer informally to the protocol specified by this technical specification. The LDAP term, as defined here, should be formally identified in other documents by a normative reference to this document.

LDAP is an extensible protocol. Extensions to LDAP may be specified in other documents. Nomenclature denoting such combinations of LDAP plus extensions is not defined by this document but may be defined in some future document(s). Extensions are expected to be optional. Considerations for the LDAP extensions described in [18](#), [RFC 4521](#) [[RFC4521](#)] fully apply to this revision of the LDAP Technical Specification.

(Internet Assigned Numbers Authority) considerations for LDAP described in [BCP 64](#), [RFC 4520](#) [[RFC4520](#)] apply fully to this revision of the LDAP technical specification.

Conventions

Key words "MUST", "MUST NOT", "REQUIRED", "SHALL", "SHALL NOT", "SHOULD", "SHOULD NOT", "RECOMMENDED", "MAY", and "OPTIONAL" in this document are to be interpreted as described in [BCP 14](#) [[RFC2119](#)].

Relationship to X.500

This technical specification defines LDAP in terms of [[X.500](#)] as an access mechanism. An LDAP server MUST act in accordance with the X.500 (1993) series of International Telecommunication Union - Telecommunication Standardization (ITU-T) Recommendations when providing the service. However, it is not required that an LDAP server make use of any X.500 protocols in providing this service. For example, LDAP can be mapped onto any other directory system so long as the X.500 data and service models [[X.501](#)][X.511], as used in the X.500 interface, are not violated in the LDAP interface.

This technical specification explicitly incorporates portions of X.500 (1993). Later revisions of X.500 do not automatically apply to this technical specification.

Relationship to Obsolete Specifications

This technical specification, as defined in [Section 1](#), obsoletes the previously defined LDAP technical specification defined in [RFC 3377](#) (and consisting of RFCs 2251-2256, 2829, 2830, 3771, and itself). The technical specification was significantly revised and reorganized.

document replaces [RFC 3377](#) as well as [Section 3.3 of RFC 2251](#). [\[512\]](#) replaces portions of [RFC 2251](#), [RFC 2252](#), and [RFC 2256](#). [\[511\]](#) replaces the majority [RFC 2251](#), portions of [RFC 2252](#), and of [RFC 3771](#). [\[RFC4513\]](#) replaces [RFC 2829](#), [RFC 2830](#), and portions of [RFC 2251](#). [\[RFC4517\]](#) replaces the majority of [RFC 2252](#) and portions of [RFC 2256](#). [\[RFC4519\]](#) replaces the majority of [RFC 2256](#). [\[514\]](#) replaces [RFC 2253](#). [\[RFC4515\]](#) replaces [RFC 2254](#). [\[RFC4516\]](#) replaces [RFC 2255](#).

[\[518\]](#) is new to this revision of the LDAP technical specification.

document of this specification contains appendices summarizing links to all sections of the specifications they replace. [Appendix A.1](#) of this document details changes made to [RFC 3377](#). [Appendix A.2](#) of this document details changes made to [Section 3.3 of RFC 2251](#).

Additionally, portions of this technical specification update and/or replace a number of other documents not listed above. These relationships are discussed in the documents detailing these portions of this technical specification.

Security Considerations

Security considerations are discussed in each document describing the technical specification.

Acknowledgements

This document is based largely on [RFC 3377](#) by J. Hodges and R. Stein, a product of the LDAPBIS and LDATEXT Working Groups. The document also borrows from [RFC 2251](#) by M. Wahl, T. Howes, and S. Varma, a product of the ASID Working Group.

This document is a product of the IETF LDAPBIS Working Group.

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Telecommunication Standardization Sector, "The
Directory: Abstract Service Definition", X.511(1993)
(also ISO/IEC 9594-3:1993).

A. Changes to Previous Documents

appendix outlines changes this document makes relative to the documents it replaces (in whole or in part).

Changes to [RFC 3377](#)

This document is nearly a complete rewrite of [RFC 3377](#) as much of the material of [RFC 3377](#) is no longer applicable. The changes include defining the terms "LDAP" and "LDAPv3" to refer to this revision of the technical specification.

Changes to [Section 3.3 of RFC 2251](#)

Section 3.3 was modified slightly (the word "document" was replaced with "technical specification") to clarify that it applies to the LDAP technical specification.

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